**KENYA MEDICAL TRAINING COLLEGE**
**FACULTY OF NURSING**
**DEPARTMENT OF NURSING**

**FINAL QUALIFYING EXAMINATION**
**FOR**
**DIPLOMA IN COMMUNITY HEALTH NURSING**

**PAPER: MEDICAL SURGICAL NURSING**

**DATE: 22nd JULY, 2024** **TIME: 3 HOURS (2:00 – 5:00 PM)**

**INSTRUCTIONS**

1. This paper consists of:
   - Section 1 (40 Multiple Choice Questions)
   - Section 2 (8 Short Answer Questions)
   - Section 3 (1 Long Answer Question)
2. Attempt **ALL** Questions
3. ALL Multiple choice questions MUST be answered in **CAPITAL LETTERS**
4. Write your **EXAMINATION NUMBER** on all the answer sheets provided and on the question paper.
5. No other writing should be done on the question paper except your Examination Number.
6. Ensure that all examination answer scripts are handed in at the end of the examination
7. Ensure you sign the examination register provided

**EXAMINATION NUMBER .....**



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## MEDICAL SURGICAL NURSING

## SECTION 1: MULTIPLE CHOICE QUESTIONS (40 MARKS)

1. You are reviewing laboratory results for a client with cirrhosis, and you note your patient has elevated ammonia levels. The diet you would recommend is:
   A. High -protein diet
   B. Moderate -fat diet
   C. High carbohydrate diet
   D. Low protein diet
2. Bronchodilators are medications used to dilate (widen) the airways in the lungs. Among the conditions in which they are contraindicated is in patients with
   A. chronic bronchitis
   B. peptic ulcer disease
   C. megaloblastic anemia
   D. chronic hepatitis
3. You are considering prescribing furosemide to a patient. The electrolyte imbalance you should watch out for is:
   A. Hyperkalemia
   B. Hypernatremia
   C. Hypokalemia
   D. Hyponatremia
4. A patient is on infusion of packed red blood cells and they develop new onset of tachycardia, bounding pulse, crackles and wheezes. The first and most appropriate action to take is:
   A. Maintain patient in bed with legs elevated and start oxygen therapy.
   B. Place the patient in high -fowler's position and start oxygen therapy.
   C. Reduce the rate of intravenous fluid infusion and start oxygen therapy.
   D. Stop the infusion of the packed cells and monitor vital signs
5. When administering blood products intravenously, it is important to use a compatible intravenous solution. The recommended choice is:
   A. Lactated Ringers
   B. Sodium chloride
   C. 5% dextrose
   D. 10% dextrose
6. In a client who sustained blunt chest trauma, acute respiratory distress syndrome (ARDS) can develop as a complication. The earliest sign of the condition is:
   A. A sense of air hunger.
   B. Decrease in respiratory rate
   C. Increase in chest pain on inspiration
   D. Pallor on extremities
7. When assessing a patient who has suffered multiple fractured rib, you would expect to find various findings related to their respiratory status. These may include:
   A. Rapid deep respirations
   B. Paradoxical respirations
   C. Slow deep respirations
   D. Painful inspirations



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8. For a client with emphysema, positioning can play a crucial role in easing breathing and improving oxygenation. The optimal position often recommended is:
   A. Fowlers
   B. Prone
   C. trendelenburg
   D. Supine
9. In a patient experiencing acute episodes of cholecystitis , the apropriate physical region for assessment of pain is:
   A. Right lower quadrant, radiating to the back
   B. Right lower quadrant, radiating to the umbilicus
   C. Right upper quadrant, radiating to the right shoulder
   D. Right upper quadrant, radiating to the left shoulder
10. In a patient with kidney failure, the electrolyte you would monitor as priority is:
   A. Sodium
   B. Potassium
   C. Chloride
   D. Magnesium
11. Ensuring adequate and safe pain control for a patient diagnosed with cancer involves a comprehensive and individualized approach: the most approriate chioce would be:
   A. Collaborate with the patient to establish a realistic pain mangement plan
   B. Keep a baseline level of pain so that the patient does not become addicted
   C. Rely primarily on prescription and the WHO analgesic ladder
   D. Gradually increasing the pain medication dose for maximum pain relieve
12. The priority action plan for a patient in the surgical ward who has just undergone arthroscopy, a minimally invasive surgical procedure used to diagnose and treat joint problems is assessing the surgical site for:
   A. adhesions and contarctions
   B. stiffness and inabilty to move
   C. bleeding and infection
   D. tingling sensations
13. Encountering an unresponsive patient who is not breathing and has no pulse is a critical emergency situation that requires immediate intervention.the first priorty action in line with basic life support regimen would be:
   A. Activate Emergency Response
   B. Position the Patient
   C. Assess Responsiveness
   D. Check for Breathing
14. When receiving clients post-anesthesia to the ward, the first action you should take is to:
   A. Check their airway, breathing, and circulation status
   B. Check the dressing to assess for bleeding and any skin discoloration
   C. Check the post-surgical instructions
   D. Check tubes or drains for patency and kinking
15. When developing a plan of care for a patient with deep vein thrombosis, it's important to include measures aimed at preventing complications such as pulmonary embolism and promoting recovery. The appropriate advice to the client would be:
   A. Elevate the affected leg above heart level when lying down
   B. Lay flat on the bed and keep the affected extremity lower than the heart level
   C. Sit up on the bed with the affected extremity flexed
   D. Elevate the affected leg with the extremities immobilized



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16. In a patient being treated for heart failure with intravenous bumetanide, an outcome that indicates the medication has achieved the expected effect is
    A. The patient cough becomes productive of frothy pink sputum
    B. The serum potassium levels change from 3.8 to 3.1 mEq/L
    C. B-natriuretic peptide factor increases from 200to 260pg/ml
    D. Urine output increases from 20ml/hour to 50 ml/hour
17. When caring for a hearing-impaired client, it's essential to use an approach that ensures effective communication and promotes their comfort and safety. The best choice would be to :
    A. Speak loudly and frequently and ensure they get used to the method of communication
    B. Ensure you are facing the client directly and maintain eye contact when addressing them
    C. Speak at a normal volume avoiding a lot of eye contact as they may feel embarrassed by constant staring
    D. Speak to the impaired ear as loudly as possible and maintain this mode of communication
18. In a patient who has just sustained a closed fracture and is experiencing intense pain despite initial interventions like elevation, ice application, and analgesic administration, several potential problems could be causing this persistent pain. Choose the most possible reason from the following:
    A. Poorly managed fracture alignment
    B. Underlying Infection under the cast
    C. Anxiety related to immobility
    D. The etiology of fracture
19. When prioritizing care among multiple patients in the ward, the decision on which patient to assess first typically depends on their clinical condition and the urgency of their needs. You have just reported on day duty and are making your plan for the day. The priority consideration will be for those patients:
    A. With Unstable Vital Signs and have been on close monitoring through the week
    B. With conditions that require frequent monitoring or interventions
    C. Who have experienced acute changes in their condition since the last assessment
    D. Who your colleague reports requires more attention as they have been in the ward for long
20. A client presenting with sudden fever, sweating, and restlessness raises concerns that could indicate a potentially serious medical condition. The most common condition and which is associated with an elderly seventy-five-year-old lady is:
    A. Pulmonary embolism
    B. Urinary tract infection
    C. Bronchitis
    D. Diabetes mellitus
21. A young man has just been received in the outpatient unit following demonstrations in the street. He complains of severe pain in the eyes and has hazy vision. The main condition to suspect would be:
    A. Glaucoma
    B. Allergic conjunctivitis
    C. Corneal ulcer
    D. Bacterial conjunctivitis



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22. You are teaching novice nursing students. The acid-base imbalance you would teach them to expect from a patient with obstructive pulmonary disease (COPD) is:
    A. Metabolic acidosis
    B. Metabolic alkalosis
    C. Respiratory acidosis
    D. Respiratory alkalosis
23. The priority intervention for an unconscious patient depends on the context and the immediate needs identified through a rapid assessment. The objective when prioritizing interventions is to:
    A. Ensure they are well taken care of as the investigations and appropraite decisions are made
    B. Establish and maintain open airway as they always present with a blocked airway.
    C. Ensure immediate stabilization and assessment to prevent further deterioration
    D. Make sure they are not deteriorating from the illness
24. When recommending dietary considerations for a patient taking iron supplements, it's essential to focus on enhancing iron absorption and ensuring a balanced diet that supports overall health. The priority choice would be:
    A. Iron-Rich Foods:
    B. Carbohydrates
    C. Vitamin C-Rich Foods:
    D. Soup from bones
25. A client has been brought to the emergency department having sustained burns on the entire front torso, front and back of left arm and the front left leg. Calculate the total burn surface area:
    A. 36%
    B. 27%
    C. 45%
    D. 18%
26. A patient has fallen from a roof and needs airway management in the emergency department, and you know the most appropriate method to open the airway depends on the patient's condition as there is suspected injuries, particularly to the cervical spine. The most appropriate method of opening the airway for this patient is:
    A. Flexed position
    B. Head tilt-chin lift
    C. Jaw thrust maneuver
    D. Modified head tilt-chin lift

27. You are inserting a nasogastric tube and the patient starts coughing and having difficulty breathing, the most appropriate intervention is to:
    A. Quickly complete inserting the tube and observe for further distress
    B. Notify the attending doctor immediately and put patient on oxygen
    C. Remove the tube and reinsert immediately and put patient on oxygen
    D. Remove the nasogastric tube immediately and wait for the distress to resolve



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28. A postmenopausal woman has presented with vaginal bleeding in the outpatient clinic. The most appropriate nursing intervention in the initial assessment is to:
    A. Offer emotional support and reassurance.
    B. Perform a thorough pelvic examination.
    C. Obtain a detailed menstrual history.
    D. Assess vital signs and hemodynamic stability.
29. A patient with glaucoma is prescribed eye drops to reduce intraocular pressure. As the nurse is administering the medication, the essential action to ensure optimal therapeutic effect is:
    A. Administer the eye drops directly onto the cornea for faster absorption.
    B. Apply gentle pressure to the lacrimal sac for after instilling the eye drops.
    C. Instruct the patient to blink vigorously for better distribution of the medication.
    D. Administer the eye drops in the conjunctival sac while the patient looks upward.
30. The Humanistic Nursing Theory emphasizes the importance of understanding patients as holistic individuals with unique needs, feelings, and experiences. The action by the nurse that best reflects the principle of this theory is:
    A. Focusing on the assessment of physiological parameters of client.
    B. Encouraging the patient's self-expression and personal choice of care
    C. Following standardized care protocols in patient care delivery.
    D. Implementing evidence-based interventions in your care.
31. In a patient with Addison's disease admitted with an adrenal crisis, the nursing action that should be prioritized is:
    A. Administering intravenous fluids
    B. Administering intravenous corticosteroids
    C. Monitoring blood glucose levels
    D. Administering a high dose of corticosteroids
32. When caring for a patient with hypothyroidism who is prescribed levothyroxine the patient asks about the best time to take the medication. The best response is:
    A. Take it with your evening meal for better absorption.
    B. Take it on an empty stomach in the morning with water.
    C. It doesn't matter; you can take it at any time of the day.
    D. Take it with calcium-rich foods for optimal effect.
33. As you walk around the hospital, the administrator asks you the primary goal of using evidence-based practice (EBP) in nursing. The appropriate response is:
    A. Reducing healthcare costs
    B. Providing standardized care
    C. Enhancing critical thinking skills
    D. Improving patient outcomes
34. When a patient refuses prescribed medication, the nurse's initial actions, based on the principles of patient advocacy, should include:
    A. Let the patient sign their choice not to take the drugs
    B. Engage in Open Communication and the explore patient Concerns
    C. Convince the patient of the medication's importance.
    D. Withhold the medication and explore the reason for refusal.



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35. The nursing process has several phases. In which phase of the nursing process does the nurse establish priorities, set goals, and create a plan of care:
   A. Assessment
   B. Diagnosis
   C. Planning
   D. Implementation

36. Natural passive immunity is acquired through the transfer of antibodies from another individual or organism without the recipient's immune system synthesizing these antibodies. One of the ways it can happen is through:
   A. Vaccination
   B. Natural birth
   C. Breastfeeding
   D. Blood transfusion

37. The priority nursing care for a patient with myocardial infarction revolves around:
   A. Administration of intravenous fluids and bed rest
   B. Administering oxygen and analgesics
   C. Proper positioning of the patient
   D. Assisting inpatient ambulation

38. The priority nursing intervention after renal transplant is:
   A. Monitoring function of the transplanted kidney and the patient's fluid status
   B. Monitoring urine output closely while patient is on fluid challenge
   C. Administration of analgesic that are prescribed and observing for toxicity
   D. Keeping the patient well hydrated to avoid complications

39. When caring for a patient on skin traction, the nurse maintains regular patient assessmen The priority finding that can impact the nursing care outcome negatively and needs strict monitoring for is:
   A. Risk of Urinary incontinence
   B. Signs of skin breakdown
   C. Risk of back injuries
   D. Itchiness on the affected limb

40. One piece of nursing assessment data that identifies a risk factor associated with catarac is:
   A. History eye infection
   B. history of migraines
   C. Advancement in age
   D. Recurrent conjunctivitis



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## SECTION 2: SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS (40 MARKS)

41. A patient is brought to the emergency department with partial thickness burn to his face, neck, arms and chest. Develop four priority nursing diagnosis you will make for the care of this patient (4 Marks)
42. The procedure for blood transfusion requires attention to detail. Explain three (3) key aspects the nurse must adhere to for successful transfusion of blood among patients (6 Marks)
43. You have been allocated in the operating theatre where many surgical operations have been scheduled for the day. Outline six (6) major categories of instruments in a general surgical set (6 Marks)
44. Outline six (6) specific responsibilities of a nurse towards a patient undergoing a liver biopsy (6 Marks)
45. The principles of drug administration in nursing encompass a set of guidelines and practices aimed at ensuring safe, effective, and ethical medication management for patients. Explain three (3) of these principles (6 Marks)
46. An elderly lady of seventy (75) years has been admitted in the orthopaedic ward following fracture of the femur. State four (4) key issues that must be considered in the choice of management for the patient (4 Marks)
47. White blood cells play an important role in the immune system. State the two types /categories of WBCs giving two examples of each. (4 Marks)
48. In a young female aged 25 years, several hormones play predominant roles in regulating various physiological processes. Explain two (2) of the hormones and the role they play (4 Marks)

## SECTION 3: LONG ANSWER QUESTION (20 MARKS)

49. You are doing a nurses round at night and notice that a known diabetic patient may have developed diabetic ketoacidosis. Describe the major clinical signs you may have observed that led you to this suspicion and for each sign illustrate the likely alterations and the measures you will take to reverse the condition. (20 marks)



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